

Phishing & Common Cyber Attacks

A Guide to Protecting Yourself Online

What is Phishing?

Phishing is when attackers send scam emails (or text messages) designed to trick you into revealing sensitive information, like your passwords, bank details, or Social Security number. They often pretend to be a trusted company (like your bank, Amazon, or Netflix) to gain your trust.

How to Spot a Phishing Attack

- **Urgent or Threatening Language:** "Your account will be suspended if you do not act immediately."
- **Generic Greetings:** "Dear Customer" instead of your real name.
- **Mismatched Sender Addresses:** The email says it's from PayPal, but the actual email address is "security@paypal-update123.com".
- **Suspicious Links:** Hover over a link (without clicking) to see the actual URL. If it looks strange, do not click.

How to Protect Yourself

- **Never click links** in unexpected emails. Go directly to the website by typing the address in your browser.
- **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on all your accounts.
- **Never download attachments** from people you do not know.

Other Common Attacks

Ransomware: Malware that locks your files until you pay a ransom. Protect yourself by keeping regular backups of your important files on an external hard drive or cloud storage.

Malware/Viruses: Software designed to harm your computer. Protect yourself by only downloading software from official websites and keeping your Operating System updated.

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